

JAVA SDE-2 INTERVIEW PREPARATION SERIES

SERIES INDEX - 4 SEGMENTS / 40 BOOKS

Java SDE-2 Interview Preparation Series Index

A Basics-to-Advanced Navigation Guide

BY

Vinay Reddy Kalluri

Choose Java, DSA, Frameworks, or System Design, then follow a clear prerequisite-aware path within the segment.

JAVA | DSA | FRAMEWORKS AND DATA | SYSTEM DESIGN

JAVA 21 | INTERVIEW CORE | SDE-2 FOLLOW-UPS | PRINTABLE EDITION

Series edition - Updated 2026-08-02

Open educational interview-preparation edition

Choose Your Learning Segment

This library has four clear paths: Java Engineering, Data Structures and Algorithms, Frameworks/Data/Messaging, and System Design. Choose the path that matches your immediate goal, then follow its numbered books in order. Frameworks and System Design intentionally build on the Java foundation.

Keep the canonical [00 - start - here](#) through [04 - system - design](#) folders together so relative links can work in viewers that permit local-file navigation. The printed series codes remain the fallback when a viewer blocks those links.

Choose your starting point in 60 seconds

Start rule: select one segment first. Inside it, begin with Book 01 unless you can pass that book's readiness checks without notes.

Your goal	Start here	Continue with
Learn or rebuild Java	JAVA 01 - Java Foundations	Continue through the Java segment in order
Build interview problem-solving skill	DSA 01 - Time and Space Complexity	Continue through the DSA segment in order
Prepare for Java backend interviews	FW 01 - MySQL	Continue through persistence, Spring, data stores, and messaging
Prepare for architecture rounds	SD 01 - Backend and Design Foundations	Continue with distributed systems after the framework path

The learning loop for every volume

- 1 **Recognize:** use the entry signals and decision maps to identify the pattern.
- 2 **Understand:** restate the contract, invariant, and failure modes in your own words.
- 3 **Implement:** type the Java example and test boundaries before looking back.
- 4 **Explain:** give the complexity, trade-offs, and one production follow-up aloud.
- 5 **Prove readiness:** pass the completion check before opening the next volume.

Part 1 - Java Engineering

Start with the language, developer workflow, build tools, core libraries, JVM, concurrency, performance, and Java interview revision.

JAVA 01 - Java Foundations for Problem Solving

This volume is the canonical Java language foundation and the recommended first book in the series. It starts with source-to-execution and program structure, builds through types, control flow, methods, arrays, strings, objects, core libraries, exceptions, generics, and usage-first collections, then converts that knowledge into interview-quality implementation and debugging skill.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-01-Java-Foundations-for-Problem-Solving.pdf](#).

JAVA 02 - Git and GitHub for Java Engineers

Build dependable Git and GitHub judgment from local snapshots through pull requests, protected branches, secure Java automation, releases, and production recovery.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-02-Git-and-GitHub.pdf](#).

JAVA 03 - Maven and Gradle for Java Engineers

Teach one durable Java build model first, map Maven and Gradle to it precisely, and develop the diagnostic and delivery judgment expected in SDE-2 interviews and production ownership.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-03-Maven-and-Gradle.pdf](#).

JAVA 04 - Language, OOP, and Modern Java

This book covers the language-engineering depth expected when SDE-2 interviews move beyond coding patterns into API design and type safety.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-04-Language-OOP-and-Modern-Java.pdf](#).

JAVA 05 - Collections, Streams, and I/O

This Java-library book complements the DSA shelf by emphasizing API contracts, representation costs, resource ownership, and production boundaries.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-05-Collections-Streams-and-IO.pdf](#).

JAVA 06 - JVM and Java Execution

This book builds the execution model needed to reason about Java behavior beneath syntax without presenting implementation details as language guarantees.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-06-JVM-and-Execution.pdf](#).

JAVA 07 - Java Concurrency and the Memory Model

This book develops concurrency correctness from first principles and then connects it to production scheduling, cancellation, backpressure, and testing.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-07-Concurrency-and-Memory-Model.pdf](#).

JAVA 08 - Performance, Diagnostics, and GC Incidents

This book teaches an evidence-first diagnostic method so performance claims and tuning actions remain falsifiable and operationally safe.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-08-Performance-Diagnostics-and-GC-Incidents.pdf](#).

JAVA 09 - Java Question Bank, Study Plan, and Reference

This book is the core Java revision system. It consolidates interview questions, selected solutions, study loops, terminology, and primary references without replacing deliberate practice.

Open [Java-SDE2-JAVA-09-Question-Bank-Study-Plan-and-Reference.pdf](#).

Part 2 - Data Structures and Algorithms

Build complexity intuition, mathematical foundations, implementation patterns, data structures, algorithms, and problem-solving confidence.

DSA 01 - Time and Space Complexity for Java Interviews

This volume is the bridge from Java syntax to algorithmic problem solving. It begins with concrete operation counts, introduces growth and space gently, then develops the qualified cost models, constraints, invariants, amortization, and optimization explanations expected in SDE-2 interviews.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-01-Time-and-Space-Complexity.pdf](#).

DSA 02 - Number Systems and Math Foundations for DSA Interviews

This volume closes the mathematical prerequisite gap before bit manipulation, arrays, binary search, hashing, and number-based coding problems. It is practical DSA mathematics, not an academic number-theory textbook.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-02-Number-Systems-and-Math-Foundations.pdf](#).

DSA 03 - Number Systems Interview Patterns and Rapid Revision

This linked workbook completes the DSA-02 numeric foundation with a 52-implementation catalog, Java number traps, conceptual and code-output questions, debugging tasks, coding exercises, solutions, follow-up chains, cheat sheet, and readiness assessment.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-03-Number-Systems-Interview-Workbook.pdf](#).

DSA 04 - Bit Manipulation in Java

This dedicated volume turns the binary foundation from DSA-02 into a progressive Java interview toolkit. It begins with visible bit patterns and safe operators, derives each shortcut instead of asking readers to memorize it, then develops XOR families, subset state, SDE-2 problem patterns, Java APIs, and production-quality bit fields.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-04-Bit-Manipulation-in-Java.pdf](#).

DSA 05 - Loop Mastery, Patterns, and Index Calculations

This volume is the bridge from basic Java control flow to reliable array and string problem solving. It begins with the execution model of for, while, do-while, and enhanced-for loops; builds a visual language for ranges and invariants; then derives pointer, compaction, window, search, and matrix patterns without asking the reader to memorize templates blindly.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-05-Loop-Mastery-and-Index-Calculations.pdf](#).

DSA 06 - Arrays and Array Problem-Solving Patterns

Arrays are the default interview state space. This volume begins with storage, indexes, references, copying, and traversal before building a constraint-driven pattern map for reliable SDE-2 solutions.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-06-Arrays-and-Array-Patterns.pdf](#).

DSA 07 - Strings and String Problem-Solving Patterns

This prerequisite-first volume takes a reader from SDE-1 String mechanics through the substring, frequency, window, parsing, and exact-search patterns expected in SDE-2 interviews. Every advanced technique follows a baseline, invariant, dry run, Java implementation, failure boundary, and complete complexity discussion.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-07-Strings-and-String-Patterns.pdf](#).

DSA 08 - Hashing: Maps, Sets, Frequency, and Prefix State

Hashing is both a DSA pattern and a Java object-contract problem. This volume connects the two so expected $O(1)$ claims remain defensible.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-08-Hashing-Maps-Sets-and-Prefix-State.pdf](#).

DSA 09 - Recursion and Backtracking in Java

This volume separates recursion as a method contract from backtracking as controlled state-space search, with Java stack and mutation behavior made explicit.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-09-Recursion-and-Backtracking.pdf](#).

DSA 10 - Linked Lists: Pointer Reasoning and Mutation

Linked-list problems expose whether a candidate can preserve reachability while mutating references. This volume makes those invariants visible.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-10-Linked-Lists.pdf](#).

DSA 11 - Stacks, Queues, Deques, and Monotonic Patterns

This volume unifies ordering data structures around the state each one preserves, then applies monotonic structures to linear-time interview patterns.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-11-Stacks-Queues-Deques-and-Monotonic-Patterns.pdf](#).

WHY IT WORKS | DSA 12 - Binary Search: Bounds, Answers, and Invariants

Binary search is a proof pattern over monotone state. This volume centers interval semantics, duplicates, insertion points, overflow-safe midpoint calculation, and search on answers.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-12-Binary-Search.pdf](#).

DSA 13 - Trees, Binary Search Trees, and Tries

Tree interviews test recursion, state ownership, structural invariants, and the ability to translate ordering into pruning.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-13-Trees-BSTs-and-Tries.pdf](#).

DSA 14 - Heaps, Priority Queues, Selection, and Top-K

This volume distinguishes heap order from global sorting and develops priority-based interview patterns without hiding comparator or mutation risks.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-14-Heaps-Priority-Queues-and-Top-K.pdf](#).

DSA 15 - Graphs: Traversal, Ordering, Paths, and Union-Find

Graph problems become manageable once the model and edge semantics are explicit. This volume emphasizes algorithm selection, state, overflow, and correctness.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-15-Graphs.pdf](#).

WHY IT WORKS | DSA 16 - Greedy Algorithms: Recognition, Proofs, and Scheduling

Greedy solutions are short to code and hard to justify. This volume centers the proof obligation, not the superficial loop.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-16-Greedy-Algorithms.pdf](#).

DSA 17 - Dynamic Programming: State, Transitions, and Optimization

This volume makes dynamic programming a specification process: define exactly what a state means, how it depends on smaller states, and what information can be compressed.

Open [Java-SDE2-DSA-17-Dynamic-Programming.pdf](#).

Part 3 - Frameworks, Data, and Messaging

Learn SQL, persistence, Spring, data stores, caching, and messaging in a prerequisite-correct Java backend path.

FW 01 - MySQL for Java Backend Interviews

Establish relational and SQL fundamentals before ORM abstractions, then build the InnoDB, indexing, concurrency, JDBC, migration, and diagnostic judgment expected from a Java SDE-2 engineer.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-01-MySQL.pdf](#).

FW 02 - Hibernate and JPA for Java Backend Interviews

Teach ORM behavior only after relational and transaction fundamentals, then make persistence-context identity, flush, fetching, query shape, batching, locking, caching, equality, and diagnosis observable and testable.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-02-Hibernate-and-JPA.pdf](#).

FW 03 - Spring Framework for Java Engineers

Build a precise Java object-graph and proxy mental model before Spring Boot automation, then develop the transaction, web, testing, concurrency, and incident judgment expected from SDE-2 backend engineers.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-03-Spring-Framework.pdf](#).

FW 04 - Spring Boot for Java Backend Engineers

Build on Spring Framework mechanics to teach how Boot assembles, configures, tests, packages, observes, secures, and operates production Java services from beginner foundations through SDE-2 incident reasoning.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-04-Spring-Boot.pdf](#).

FW 05 - Spring Boot and REST APIs

This book develops the Spring and HTTP reasoning expected in Java SDE-2 interviews while keeping framework behavior tied to explicit contracts and failure modes.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-05-Spring-Boot-and-REST.pdf](#).

FW 06 - Spring Data for Java Backend Engineers

Build strong repository-first reasoning, query-shape confidence, transaction correctness, and performance awareness before and during SDE-2 interviews.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-06-Spring-Data.pdf](#).

FW 07 - MongoDB for Java Backend Interviews

Teach when document storage fits and how schema, indexing, consistency, and access patterns drive the design.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-07-MongoDB.pdf](#).

FW 08 - Redis for Java Backend Interviews

Teach Redis as a distinct system with explicit consistency and failure boundaries, not merely a fast map.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-08-Redis.pdf](#).

FW 09 - Persistence, SQL, JPA, and Caching

This book develops the persistence judgment needed to design correct, measurable Java data paths instead of treating databases, ORMs, and caches as interchangeable storage APIs.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-09-Persistence-SQL-and-Caching.pdf](#).

FW 10 - Apache Kafka and Spring Kafka

Keep Apache Kafka semantics and Spring Kafka integration together while teaching the platform model before framework abstractions.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-10-Apache-Kafka-and-Spring-Kafka.pdf](#).

FW 11 - Spring Ecosystem Extensions

Teach the major Spring extensions from prerequisites and runtime mechanics through SDE-2 trade-offs without implying every service needs every module.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-11-Spring-Ecosystem-Extensions.pdf](#).

FW 12 - Spring AI for Java Engineers

Place Spring AI after the core backend and Spring foundations so AI integration is taught as production software engineering.

Open [Java-SDE2-FW-12-Spring-AI.pdf](#).

Part 4 - System Design

Move from component boundaries to distributed-system reasoning after the Java backend foundations are secure.

SD 01 - Design, Backend, Testing, and Security

This book covers the engineering judgment that distinguishes SDE-2 candidates from syntax-only candidates: boundaries, invariants, failure policy, observability, and maintainability.

Open [Java-SDE2-SD-01-Design-Backend-Testing-and-Security.pdf](#).

SD 02 - Distributed Systems and System Design

This book applies a constraint-first system-design method spanning distributed data, messaging, failure control, and operations.

Open [Java-SDE2-SD-02-Distributed-Systems-and-System-Design.pdf](#).

Part 5 - Recommended Study Rhythm

Build, Practice, Explain, Revisit

For each volume, complete one learning pass, one no-notes implementation pass, one spoken explanation pass, and one delayed revision pass. Keep an error log organized by contract, invariant, numeric safety, data-structure choice, complexity, and test coverage. A roadmap edition establishes ordering and scope; return as its chapter set expands rather than treating it as finished instruction.

Contents

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Series Roadmap

Choose Java, DSA, Frameworks, or System Design first, then follow the books inside that segment in order. The same series codes and positions appear on the website, PDF covers, and canonical download folders.

SEGMENT	BOOK	FOCUSED LEARNING PATH
Java	JAVA 01	Java Foundations for Problem Solving
Java	JAVA 02	Git and GitHub for Java Engineers
Java	JAVA 03	Maven and Gradle for Java Engineers
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Java	JAVA 07	Java Concurrency and the Memory Model
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DSA	DSA 10	Linked Lists: Pointer Reasoning and Mutation
DSA	DSA 11	Stacks, Queues, Deques, and Monotonic Patterns
DSA	DSA 12	Binary Search: Bounds, Answers, and Invariants
DSA	DSA 13	Trees, Binary Search Trees, and Tries
DSA	DSA 14	Heaps, Priority Queues, Selection, and Top-K
DSA	DSA 15	Graphs: Traversal, Ordering, Paths, and Union-Find
DSA	DSA 16	Greedy Algorithms: Recognition, Proofs, and Scheduling
DSA	DSA 17	Dynamic Programming: State, Transitions, and Optimization
Frameworks	FW 01	MySQL for Java Backend Interviews
Frameworks	FW 02	Hibernate and JPA for Java Backend Interviews
Frameworks	FW 03	Spring Framework for Java Engineers
Frameworks	FW 04	Spring Boot for Java Backend Engineers
Frameworks	FW 05	Spring Boot and REST APIs

SEGMENT	BOOK	FOCUSED LEARNING PATH
Frameworks	FW 06	Spring Data for Java Backend Engineers
Frameworks	FW 07	MongoDB for Java Backend Interviews
Frameworks	FW 08	Redis for Java Backend Interviews
Frameworks	FW 09	Persistence, SQL, JPA, and Caching
Frameworks	FW 10	Apache Kafka and Spring Kafka
Frameworks	FW 11	Spring Ecosystem Extensions
Frameworks	FW 12	Spring AI for Java Engineers
System Design	SD 01	Design, Backend, Testing, and Security
System Design	SD 02	Distributed Systems and System Design

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About the Author

Vinay Reddy Kalluri

Vinay Reddy Kalluri is a senior Java backend engineer and the author and editor of the Java SDE-2 Interview Preparation Series. His work spans high-throughput microservices, event-driven architecture, resilient APIs, large-scale data processing, cloud delivery, and production performance across healthcare and enterprise systems.

Editorial approach

Vinay sets the learning sequence and publication standard and performs the final review for Java accuracy, evidence, attribution, and release readiness. Individual contributors retain visible credit for accepted original work through AUTHORS.md and the public Git history.

What distinguishes his approach is the combination of hands-on system design and operational ownership. He treats timeouts, retries, idempotency, dead-letter recovery, data consistency, SQL behavior, caching, and observability as part of the design rather than afterthoughts. He has also mentored engineers and led modernization, migration, and reliability work across distributed services.

Selected engineering and academic highlights

- More than eight years building Java and Spring Boot services for high-throughput healthcare and enterprise platforms.
- Designed Kafka-based event systems that have processed more than one million events per hour, with explicit idempotency, retry, recovery, and observability controls.
- M.S. in Computer Science from the University of Missouri-Kansas City (3.9/4.0) and M.S. in Software Engineering from VIT University (9.3/10), where he was a Gold Medalist.
- Independent builder of Work Visa Insights, an immigration-data intelligence platform, and Play Together, a published Android application.

Why this series exists

Vinay created this series to turn fragmented interview preparation into a deliberate progression: learn the fundamentals, run the examples, predict behavior, debug failures, explain trade-offs, and only then move into advanced engineering. The books reflect the same principle he applies to production systems: clarity before cleverness, explicit contracts, measurable behavior, and reliable foundations.

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Repository: <https://github.com/vinayreddykalluri/SDE2-Interview-Handbook>. Attribution does not imply endorsement. Java and related marks are owned by their respective holders.

Examples target Java 21 unless a section states otherwise. Validate release-specific APIs, JVM behavior, security, performance, licensing, and operational requirements before production use.

Series position: Series Index - 4 Segments / 40 Books. The local table of contents and PDF bookmarks navigate within this file; the roadmap and printed filenames navigate across the complete series.

Source provenance: curated from the independent Java SDE-2 master guide plus focused original material. Original master chapter numbers are labeled explicitly when retained in cross-references.